

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 5 3
♥ Q 5 4
♦ A Q 4 2
♣ 10 4 3

♠ K 8

♥ J 10 7

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A K J 6 2



♠ Q J 6

♥ K 6 2

♦ J 10 8 3

♣ 9 8 5

♠ A 9 7 4 2

♥ A 9 8 3

♦ K 6

♣ Q 7

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♦ ¹	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
1. 4th suit			

South opens 1 ♠ - how do you respond? With 13 points, you respond 2 ♣, a natural 2/1 force to game. South next bids 2 ♥, showing the other Major suit. What do you rebid now? You assume South to be 5-4 in the Majors, so you cannot support either. You cannot bid 2NT without a stopper in ♦ s. So you bid the fourth suit, 3 ♦, telling South you know you must make a bid, but can't find anything appropriate. This is an artificial bid, and normally denies a diamond stopper (otherwise you would have bid 2NT). South rebids 3NT - what do you do now?

South now must find a bid. His choices include rebidding the 5-card ♠ s, supporting North's ♣ s with a doubleton Queen, or bidding 3NT with the ♦ K 6 as a stopper. He chooses this last option. It appears that 3NT is the best game for these two hands.

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 8 2

♥ 9

♦ 10 8 7 5

♣ K 5 4 2

♠ K J 7 6 3

♥ A Q 7

♦ J 4

♣ A Q J



♠ Q 5

♥ 4 2

♦ A 9 6 3 2

♣ 10 9 6 3

♠ A 4

♥ K J 10 8 6 5 3

♦ K Q

♣ 8 7

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♥

Pass

3 ♥

Pass

3 ♠¹

Pass

4 ♣²

Pass

4NT

Pass

5 ♠³

Pass

6 ♥

All Pass

1. control

2. control

3. 2 keycards + trump Q

How do you open the bidding? With 18 HCP and a balanced hand, you open 1 ♠. Partner responds 2 ♥. What do you rebid? You know this is a 5-card suit, and bid 3 ♥, confirming the 8+card trump fit and sets the trump suit. Partner rebids 3 ♠, a control bid, showing first or second round control. (Some will play this as showing 3-card support for spades, but I recommend playing this as a control bid.). You bid 4C, also a control bid, showing first or second round control in clubs. Partner bids 4NT, a keycard request using 1430.

You bid 5 ♠, showing two keycards and the trump queen. Partner bids the slam. The slam is a good one. If either the ♠Q or ♣K is right there are 12 tricks by way of a finesse. But the best way to play the hand would be to try to establish a ♠ in the North hand, and if that fails try the ♣ finesse.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 2
 ♥ Q J 4 2
 ♦ 10 8 5 3
 ♣ 9 2

♠ 8 6 3

♥ 7 3

♦ A Q 4

♣ A K J 10 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 7 5 4

♥ 10 6

♦ J 7 2

♣ 8 6 5 3

♠ A J 10

♥ A K 9 8 5

♦ K 9 6

♣ Q 7

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1 ♥
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT	Pass	4NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

South opens 1 ♥ - how should you respond? South rebids 2NT. How do you continue? North shows her minimum by bidding 3NT. South continues with 4NT - what does this mean? How do you continue?

South's 4NT was not Blackwood, but rather a quantitative raise in Notrump, and an invitation to slam. You have 15 points, and they are good ones. So you accept the invitation and bid 6NT. There are 11 top tricks. A 3-3 ♥ split would provide the 12th winner, but this is against the odds. Better to try two ♠ finesses, a 75% chance.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 4
 ♥ J 10 5 4
 ♦ 8 5 3
 ♣ Q 10 5 3

♠ Q 6 3

♥ Q 3

♦ A K J 9 4

♣ 9 6 4



♠ K 10

♥ 9 8 7 6 2

♦ 10 7 2

♣ A K 2

♠ A J 8 7 5 2

♥ A K

♦ Q 6

♣ J 8 7

South opens 1♠ - You responds 2♦, natural and game forcing. South rebids 2♠. In our style of 2/1, this promises 6+ cards in spades, and denies a side 4-card suit. What should we bid now?

You should jump to 4♠. This is Fast Arrival, indicating a minimum hand with no particular interest in slam. South is happy to rest in the game contract. Even with a combined 30 points, 10 tricks are certainly not a sure thing. South must hope that East holds the trump King.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		Pass	1♠
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			